

Power Tips for Maximising CD-Writer Performance



- Enable ASPI (Advanced SCSI Protocol Interface). ASPI drivers mainly consist of these four files: apix.vxd, apium.vxd, winaspi.dll, and wnaspi32.dll. They allow the CD-Writing software to access the hardware.
- Keep your hard drive in top condition by regularly running disk tools like Scandisk and Disk Defragmenter.
- Disable programs running in the background (screensavers, alerts, anti-virus programs, etc) to free up system resources.
- Shut down all other applications while burning CDs; do not use the computer for any other tasks while a CD is burning.
- For a CD-to-CD copy, always create an image before writing.
- Keep the firmware versions up to date. Check the manufacturer's Web site for latest updates.
- If you use an ATAPI (IDE) CD-RW drive, make sure it's on a different IDE channel than the hard drive. PCs come with at least two IDE channels (primary and secondary) built into the motherboard. Each channel supports two IDE devices on a single cable: a master and a slave. Hard drives should always be on the primary channel, and ATAPI devices (if any) should be on the secondary channel. Preferably keep your CD-Writer as the secondary master device.
- Disable auto insert notification from **Start > Setting > Control Panel > System > Device Manager > CD ROM > Device Name > Settings**.
- Windows 98 users can increase the disk cache for frequently used hard-disk data. Select **Start > Settings > Control Panel**,

double-click the System icon, choose the Performance tab, select File System, click the Hard Disk tab, and under 'Typical role of this computer', change 'Desktop computer' to 'Network server'.

- If you need to burn a CD while you are still on the network, disable 'File and Print Sharing' under Network Properties, to prevent other users from accessing your hard drive.
- Enable DMA from **Start > Setting > Control Panel > System > Device Manager > CD ROM > Device Name > Setting > DMA**. This helps the device to directly talk to the hard drive rather than going through the CPU and then accessing the drive.
- If you have a fast CD-Writer but a slow processor and hard disk subsystem (ATA 33), it is safer to burn the CD at a speed lower than the maximum possible.
- Use Track-At-Once instead of Disk-At-Once to burn an Audio CD. This will make the Audio CD look more professional because a 2 second gap will be inserted between each burned track and the CD can then be mass produced error-free.
- Always finalise a burned Audio CD to ensure that it plays on your home music system.
- Use branded CDs for burning critical data—cheaper media are prone to damage and can't hold data for long.
- Try to simulate a burn process if the CD-Writer has just presented you with a coaster. Most CD-Writing software will allow this.

Workshop: Using CD-Writers

How to Make a Bootable CD using Nero

Step 1: Get a bootable CD or a bootable floppy of the operating system to make the new bootable CD.

Step 2: Start Nero and select the CD-ROM (boot) in the main window. You will be greeted with a new window with an option where you can select the drive in which the bootable floppy/CD is located. Here, make sure the bootable media is in the drive, otherwise the drive letter will not be highlighted.



Step 3: Put the blank media in the CD-Writer and leave the ISO and Misc tab as it is. Give the appropriate name in the label section for the bootable CD. Select the

Burn tab and check the write and Finalize the CD. Select the Disc-at-Once write method and click on the New tab.

Step 4: Since the bootable CD will be left with lots of unused space, it can be utilised to burn drivers and updates for your PC.

Step 5: Select the Write tab and in the window which opens, select the safe writing speed according to the configuration of your machine.

Step 6: Now you are ready to write the CD. The typical size of the bootable CD for windows 98SE should come to around 125 MB and it will take around 4 to 5 minutes to complete the process.

Step 7: Check by booting the system with the CD you burned.

Make Music CDs using Nero

You can also burn CDs using Nero Burning ROM

Step 1: Click on **Start > Programs > Ahead Nero > Nero Burning ROM**.

Step 2: Select the Audio CD option and click on the Next button.

Step 3: Use the Finish button to confirm all the details.

Step 4: Select the songs you wish to save on the CD from the File Browser on the right side of the screen. Drag them to the Compilation window on the left by holding down the left button on your mouse.

Step 5: Once you have dragged all the files across, you are ready to save (or 'burn') to a CD. Go to **File > Write CD...** option to launch the Burn CD Wizard.

Step 6: Click the Burn button to start writing process.

Step 7: Once your CD has been written, click the Discard button. You can now retrieve your recorded CD from the drive.

Note: After the burning process is over. To exit from Nero, select **File > Exit** from the menu bar. Now you will be greeted with a window asking you to save the session. Click the No button.

